

Task 11: Phishing Attack Simulation & Detection

1. Understand phishing attacks

Phishing is a type of cyber-attack where attackers trick people into sharing sensitive information like passwords, OTPs, or bank details. They usually do this through fake emails, messages, or websites that look genuine. The main goal is to exploit human trust rather than breaking technical systems.

2. Create fake email template

In a simulation, a fake email template is created to look like a real one (for example, a bank alert or company notice). The language, logo, and tone are designed to appear urgent or important. This helps in understanding how easily users can be influenced by realistic-looking emails.

3. Setup landing page

A landing page is a fake website where the email link redirects the user. It is made to resemble a real login page but does not actually collect real data in a training setup. This step helps demonstrate how attackers capture user credentials.

4. Send test phishing email

The phishing email is sent only to test users in a controlled environment. This is done to observe how users react—whether they click the link, ignore it, or report it. No real harm is caused during this step.

5. Track responses

Responses such as email opens, link clicks, or form submissions are tracked. This data helps in understanding user awareness levels. It shows how many users are vulnerable to phishing attempts.

6. Identify red flags

Red flags include suspicious sender addresses, spelling mistakes, urgent messages, unknown links, and requests for personal information. Learning to spot these signs helps users avoid falling for real phishing attacks.

7. Learn prevention

Prevention includes user awareness training, using strong passwords, enabling two-factor authentication, and not clicking unknown links. Email filters and security tools also help block phishing emails before they reach users.

8. Document simulation

All steps, observations, and results are documented clearly. This documentation helps in improving future security training and awareness programs. It also shows how phishing risks can be reduced with proper education and controls.